

Sweden

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1. Study Courses That Qualify (Claude)

The relevant visa/permit category covers higher education study: National visas (marked with D symbol and annotation '09', 'student') or temporary residence permits for the purpose of studying at a higher education institution are issued to third-country nationals, whose purpose of stay in Poland are full-time studies or PhD studies justifying stay for a period longer than 3 months. [European Commission](#)

Importantly, not every institution automatically qualifies: the higher education institution should be approved by the Minister of the Interior for the purpose of admission of third-country students. Public and non-public University-type higher education institutions (HEIs) as well as public professional HEIs are exempted from the approval obligation. So if you're enrolling at a public university or recognized HEI, you're generally covered automatically; smaller or non-standard providers should be checked against the official approval list. [European Commission](#)

There's also a special "student mobility" pathway if you're already studying in another EU country and want to do part of your degree in Poland — you may carry out part of your studies and work in Poland... you may reside and study in Poland for up to 360 days, provided your existing programme involves an EU/multilateral mobility agreement. [European Commission](#)

2. Embassy/Consulate Appointment

Booking goes through Poland's dedicated portal: the visa application can be completed online and printed, however there is no possibility to apply for a visa online. The only electronically operated part of the visa application procedure is the reservation of the date and time of the meeting in the consulate and registration of the application via the e-Konsulat portal. [European Commission](#)

In practice: in most cases, you will have to register through the website: <https://secure.e-konsulat.gov.pl/>. After registering, printed and signed applications should be submitted to the consular offices. In some locations (Belarus, China, India, Philippines, Turkey and Ukraine), applications can be submitted via the External Service Provider (commonly VFS Global), where staff can help you fill in the form. [Study in Poland](#)[European Commission](#)

A practical tip from official consulate guidance: appointments for Schengen visa as well as national visa registrations for the purpose other than employment are made available systematically in the "Register Form" of the e-konsulat system every first

Wednesday of the month — slots are released on a first-come-first-served basis, so it's worth checking the portal right when new slots open. [Gov.pl](#)

3. Steps to Apply for a Study Visa

Two-stage process: first the national visa (D-type) from abroad, then a temporary residence permit after arrival if you're staying past the visa's validity.

Documents needed for the visa: completed visa application form; valid travel document (validity expiring no earlier than 3 months after the visa expiry, with at least two blank pages, issued within the past 10 years); up-to-date biometric photograph; proof of payment of the visa fee, plus the supporting documents listed in Question 4. [European Commission](#)

How to apply: Register and book your consulate appointment via e-Konsulat → print and sign the application → submit in person with documents and fee at the consulate (or ESP/VFS centre in some countries).

How long it takes: a national visa or a decision refusing to issue this visa shall be issued within 30 days from the date of submission of the application together with the documents necessary to confirm the data contained in the application. If anything's missing, the applicant has the right to supplement them within 7 days from the date of submission of the application. [European Commission](#)[European Commission](#)

4. Documents to Prepare

Beyond the basic visa form and passport, you'll need: a certificate of an entity conducting studies concerning the enrolling for their study programme... evidence of payment of the fee for studies if applicable; documents confirming the third-country national is covered by public health insurance in Poland or the confirmation of the private insurer's coverage of the medical treatment costs on the territory of Poland. Health insurance has a specific threshold for visa applicants: travel medical insurance for a minimum sum insured of 30,000 euros, valid for the period of the intended stay... covering repatriation for medical reasons, urgent medical attention, emergency hospital treatment or death. [European Commission](#)[European Commission](#)

You also need proof of financial resources (see Question 5) and proof of accommodation.

5. Money Requirements

This is calculated as a precise monthly minimum, tied to costs of living separately from accommodation: the amount of monthly funds, upon deducting the funds dedicated to cover the costs of residence, should exceed 776 PLN for single persons or 600 PLN for persons in the family. [European Commission](#)

You also need to budget for **return travel costs**, with the figure depending on where you're traveling from: acceptable amounts are 200 PLN in case of arrival from a neighbouring country, 500 PLN from other EU/EEA Member States or Switzerland, 2500 PLN from other countries. [European Commission](#)

Acceptable proof includes student loan/scholarship documentation, a parental sponsorship statement, or your own bank statements — and don't forget, you also need to show you can cover the cost of your studies themselves, not just living expenses.

6. Applying for a Residence Permit After Arrival

This is the **Temporary Residence Permit**, applied for at the local **Voivodship (Provincial) Office**: the third-country national makes the application in person, no later than on the last day of the lawful residence on the territory of Poland, to the governmental province authority (voivode) competent in respect of his/her place of residence. You should make an appointment early enough. [European Commission](#)

Biometrics are collected during this process: while submitting the application, the third-country national is under the obligation to give his/her fingerprints. [European Commission](#)

Costs: stamp duty PLN 340 (approx. 77 euros). Fee for issuing a residence card PLN 100 (approx. 23 euros). [European Commission](#)

Timing: the procedure should end within 60 days from the day of making a complete application. The third-country national who has obtained the temporary residence permit is issued with a residence card. [European Commission](#)

7. Working While Studying

Yes — and notably, Poland places **no specific hour cap** on student work, unlike many other EU countries: holders of a national visa with a 'student' annotation or temporary residence permit for the purpose of studying at a higher education institution may perform work in Poland without the need to have a work permit. The residence card, issued in connection with temporary residence permit, includes apart from an annotation 'student', also an annotation 'access to the labour market.' [European Commission](#)

You can also start a business: holders of the temporary residence permit issued for that purpose may undertake and conduct business activity on the territory of the Republic of Poland on the same terms as Polish citizens. [European Commission](#)

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

The first permit is intentionally generous in length, often covering more than one academic year already:

The first temporary residence permit for the purpose of studies is granted for a period of 15 months. If the studies justify the stay of a third-country national on the territory of Poland for a period shorter than 15 months, the first permit is granted for the term of the academic year or the studies, extended by 3 months. [European Commission](#)

If your programme involves an EU mobility agreement: where the studies are covered by an EU programme or a multilateral programme involving mobility measures or an agreement between at least two higher education institutions, the first temporary residence permit is granted for 2 years. [European Commission](#)

For longer programmes, subsequent renewals follow: a subsequent temporary residence permit for studies is granted for the period necessary for achieving the goal of stay on the territory of Poland, however the duration cannot be longer than 3 years. [European Commission](#)

Renewal conditions and documentation are the same as the original application: conditions for renewal: the same as above. [European Commission](#)

9. Changing to a Work Permit After Studies

Yes, Poland has a defined transition route open to graduates: change of status: possible if conditions for other status are met. Right to apply for a temporary residence permit for the purpose of job-searching or setting up a business after the completion of studies. [European Commission](#)

One restriction to flag: holders of a temporary residence permit for the purpose of studying at a higher education institution cannot apply for a temporary residence permit for the purpose of performing work as part of an intra-corporate transfer. Outside that specific category, though, the standard jobseeker/business-creation route and standard work-based residence permits remain open once you graduate and find employment or set up a business. [European Commission](#)

10. Official Government Information

The two authoritative sources are:

- **study.gov.pl** — the official Polish government portal for international students, covering visas and applications
- **mos.cudzoziemcy.gov.pl** (the Foreigners' Service portal, run by the Office for Foreigners) — for detailed legal procedures, documents, and the temporary residence permit process
- **gov.pl/web/diplomacy** — the Ministry of Foreign Affairs site, including the visa fee schedule and list of approved health insurers

For appeals and legal recourse: a third-country national not satisfied with a decision concerning granting the residence permit may appeal before the Head of the Office for Foreigners within 14 days. Moreover, it is possible to bring a further appeal before the administrative courts. For visa refusals specifically: a third-country national who received a negative decision on issuing a visa may submit in person within 14 days a request to a consul for re-examination of the application. [European Commission](#)

11. Official Application Forms

- The **national visa application form** is available through the e-Konsulat portal (secure.e-konsulat.gov.pl) and the Ministry of Foreign Affairs visa pages (gov.pl/web/diplomacy/visas).
- The **temporary residence permit application form** and detailed instructions are hosted on the Office for Foreigners' portal at mos.cudzoziemcy.gov.pl (English-language section available), under the "na studia" (for studies) information pages.

12. Common Mistakes & Tips

- **Applying too close to your visa expiry** — since the temporary residence permit application must be submitted no later than on the last day of the lawful residence, leaving it to the last minute risks falling out of legal status if the Voivodship Office appointment isn't available in time. Book early. [European Commission](#)
- **Incomplete documentation at submission** — both the visa and residence permit processes give you only a short window (7 days) to supply missing documents before the application is rejected or returned, so double-check your file before submitting.
- **Underestimating health insurance requirements** — the 30,000 EUR minimum coverage for visa applicants is specific and not all travel insurance policies meet it; verify against the approved insurer list on gov.pl before purchasing.
- **Confusing the monthly financial threshold** — the 776 PLN figure is calculated *after* deducting accommodation costs, and it's separate from tuition and return-travel cost proof. Applicants sometimes only show one piece of this and get asked for more documentation.
- **Assuming all institutions are pre-approved** — if you're enrolling somewhere outside the standard public/recognized HEI category, check the Minister of Interior's approval list, since unapproved institutions can't sponsor a valid student visa application.
- **Missing the post-study transition deadline** — the jobseeker/business-creation residence permit needs to be applied for before your student permit expires, so

plan your post-graduation timeline in advance rather than waiting to see if you find a job first.

1. Study Courses (Gemini)

To qualify for a Residence Permit for Studies, you must be admitted to an accredited higher education provider in Sweden.

- **Eligible course types:** Full-time programs at universities and university colleges (Bachelor's, Master's, or PhD programs), or preparatory courses leading to such higher education.
- Distance learning or part-time programs **do not** qualify you for a residence permit.

2. Embassy Appointment

The initial application process is entirely digital via the Swedish Migration Agency portal.

- After submitting your online application and paying the processing fee, you will receive an automated request to book an in-person appointment.
- You must book an appointment at a designated **Swedish Embassy or Consulate-General** in your country of residence to show your original passport and complete your biometric enrollment (photo and fingerprints).

3. Applying for a Study Visa (Residence Permit)

In Sweden, this is a **Residence Permit for Studies** rather than an entry visa.

- **How to apply:** 1. Secure admission via the national application portal ([universityadmissions.se](https://www.universityadmissions.se)).
2. Pay your first tuition fee installment directly to your university.
 3. Submit an online application through the Swedish Migration Agency (**Migrationsverket**) portal.
 4. Complete your passport verification and biometrics at a Swedish embassy.
 - **Processing time:** It typically takes **8 to 12 weeks**. You should apply immediately after paying your tuition installment, usually by April/May for the autumn semester.

4. Documents Needed

Before submitting your online application, you must prepare clear color scans of:

- A valid passport (all pages containing stamps, text, or visual details).
- The official **Notification of Selection Results** (admission letter) proving full-time acceptance.
- A receipt or confirmation showing you have paid the **first tuition installment**.
- Proof of valid **comprehensive health insurance** (only required if your course lasts *less than one year*; programs longer than one year automatically integrate you into the Swedish healthcare system).
- Detailed **financial documentation** showing sufficient funds.

5. Money Requirements

The maintenance requirement ensures you can fully support yourself while living in Sweden:

- **The Threshold:** You must prove you have at least **SEK 10,656 per month** for the entire requested duration of your permit. For a typical 10-month academic year, this requires a minimum accessible balance of **SEK 106,560**.
- **Acceptable Formats:** Bank statements in your own name from an open checking/savings account, a formal scholarship award document, or an official student loan agreement.
- **Important Caveat:** Sponsorship letters or bank statements belonging to third parties (like friends or extended relatives) are generally **not** accepted unless they are formal institutional funds or bank accounts under your absolute legal control.

6. Residence Permit Card

Since you apply for and receive approval for the residence permit *before* entering Sweden, you do not need to apply for it upon arrival.

- **Biometric Step:** If your country requires an entry visa, your physical **Residence Permit Card (UT-kort)** will be sent to your local embassy for collection before travel. If you are from a visa-exempt country, you enter Sweden with your decision letter and print your card locally.
- **Registration Obligation:** You must notify Migrationsverket of your physical Swedish address within **30 days** of arrival. Additionally, if your course lasts more than one year, you must register at the Swedish Tax Agency (**Skatteverket**) to receive a personal identity number (*personnummer*).

7. Working While Studying

- **Hours Allowed:** Non-EU students are restricted to a maximum of **15 hours per week** during active term time. Working more hours can lead to the revocation or non-renewal of your permit.

- **Holidays:** Full-time work is permitted during formal university holiday blocks (e.g., summer and winter breaks).
- **Requirement:** You must maintain acceptable academic progress regardless of your work schedule.

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

If your higher education track extends across multiple academic years, you must file a renewal request before your current permit expires.

- **Academic Thresholds:** You must prove satisfactory academic progress. This means achieving at least **37.5 credits** during your first year of study, and at least **45 credits** per year for any subsequent years.
- **Submission:** Renewals are processed online via Migrationsverket. You must upload updated transcripts from the *Ladok* system, a new bank statement showing the maintenance fund for the upcoming year, and pay the renewal fee (SEK 1,500).

9. Changing to a Work Permit

Upon completing your degree program, you can seamlessly transition to the Swedish job market.

- **Job Search Extension:** You can apply for a specialized residence permit to **look for work or explore starting a business**, which grants you an extra **12 months** to live in Sweden after graduation.
- **Transition to Work Permit:** Once you receive an employment offer that meets national collective agreement standards and minimum salary thresholds, you can apply directly for a **Work Permit** from within Sweden, provided you have successfully completed at least two semesters of your higher education program.

10. Official Information

Always check official, up-to-date state portals for legislative updates:

- **Swedish Migration Agency:** migrationsverket.se
- **Official Guide to Higher Education in Sweden:** studyinsweden.se

11. Application Forms

- Sweden uses a highly paperless, digital portal system. You can access all online application wizards and electronic submission queues by setting up an account on the **Migrationsverket E-services platform**.

12. Tips for Students (Common Mistakes to Avoid)

- **Incomplete Passport Scans:** Migrationsverket will heavily delay or refuse your file if you only scan the biometric page. You must upload high-quality color scans of *every single page* of your passport, including blank pages and covers.
- **Falling Behind on Credits:** If you fail to hit the required academic credit marks (e.g., 37.5 credits in year one), your extension will be denied. Ensure you are passing your courses before applying for a renewal.
- **Third-Party Bank Accounts:** Submitting bank statements belonging to uncles, family friends, or private sponsors without a clear, unassailable institutional paper trail will result in an immediate rejection. Funds must be sitting in an account under your own name.